

PATIENT INFORMATION SHEET

BENZOIC ACID

(B-005)

Your patch testing results indicate that you have a contact allergy to **BENZOIC ACID**. It is important that you familiarize yourself with this chemical and take steps to avoid coming in contact with it.

What is **BENZOIC ACID** and where is it found?

This is a chemical food preservative. It is used as an antifungal agent and can be found in acidic food, fruit juices, sparkling drinks, and pickles. It is also used for curing tobacco and is present in plasticizers, perfumes, cosmetics and dentifrices. Further research may identify additional product or industrial usages of this chemical.

What else is **BENZOIC ACID** called?

This chemical can be identified by different names, including:

Benzenecarboxylic Acid, Phenylformic acid, Benzene formic acid, Retarded ba, Benzenemethonic Acid, Retardex, Carboxybenzene, Salvo, Diaclyic acid, Tennplas, Phenyl carboxylic acid, Oracylic Acid

This may not be a complete list as manufacturers introduce and delete chemicals from their product lines.

THINGS YOU CAN DO TO HELP MANAGE YOUR CONTACT ALLERGY

Be vigilant... read the product label. Always take the time to read the ingredient listing on product packages.

This should be your first step each time you purchase a product as manufacturers sometimes change product ingredients. If you have any concerns ask your pharmacist or your doctor.

Test the product first. If you have purchased a new product you should test it on a small skin area to see if you get a reaction before using the product on larger skin areas.

Advise people you obtain services from of your contact allergy. This should include people like your pharmacist, doctor, hairdresser, florist, veterinarian, etc.

Inform your employer if the source of your contact allergy is work related. You should identify the specific source of the chemical and take the necessary steps to avoid further exposure. Protective wear may be adequate or you may need to make a change in your work activities. Both you and your employer benefit when the cause of your occupational dermatitis is eliminated.

"Google" it. The internet is an excellent source of ingredient information that can be searched by product, by company and by specific chemical. Some helpful independent internet links

include: www.nlm.nih.gov/pubs/factsheets/factsheets.html (U.S. Dept. of Health and Human Services; alphabetic list) www.nlm.nih.gov/pubs/factsheets/factssubj.html (U.S. Dept. of Health and Human Services; subject list) www.cosmeticsinfo.org (Cosmetic Industry Category Ingredient Database) www.whatsinsidescjohnson.com (information on all S.C. Johnson product ingredients)

If you have any future contact dermatitis concerns or questions, please call the doctor's office.

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